15. Middleton, Britain and Russia. An Historical Essay , p. 79.

16. Williams, 'The Strategic Backround to the Anglo-Russian Entente of August 1907', The Historical Journal , Vol. 9 (1966), p. 369.

17. For an excellent work on the true extent of Germany's eastern ambitions, see McMeekin, The Berlin-Baghdad Express: The Ottoman Empire and Germany's Bid for World Power 1898–1918 (hereafter Berlin-Baghdad). For further information regarding the situation in the Persian Gulf, see Busch, Britain and the Persian Gulf, 1894–1914 and Kelly, 'The Legal and Historical Basis of the British Position in the Persian Gulf', St. Antony's Papers (1958), pp. 119–40.

18. See Grant, ed., The Kaiser's Letters to the Tsar .

19. Lieven, op. cit., p. 28.

20. Neilson, Last Tsar , pp. 30–1.

21. Seeger, ed., Memoirs of Alexander Iswolsky , pp. 43–5.

22. By lending its support to the Austrian-Hungarian annexation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, Germany was attempting to demonstrate the strength of the Central Powers compared to the weakness of the Triple Entente: Neilson, Last Tsar , p. 306.

23. By 1909, Russia was pressing Britain for a conversion of the Convention into a formal alliance: Nicolson, Sir Arthur Nicolson Bart, First Lord Carnock. A Study in the Old Diplomacy , pp. 313–14.

24. Ibid ., pp. 269–75.

25. Neilson, Last Tsar , pp. 322–3.

26. Churchill, The Anglo-Russian Convention of 1907 , p. 349.

27. Sazonov, op. cit., p. 23.

28. Middleton, Britain and Russia , p. 92.